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UMAX



Delete and Send to Recycle Bin?



Tux as a Garbage Bin: Bill Gates' fantasy comes true at Goa's Karmali Railway Station. Sent by **Rohini Sharma**, Goa

inconvenience." The damage was far in excess to the bit of trouble he was looking to cause as Scotland Yard's computer crime unit would attest to.

The law questioned him and then later released him on bail. If convicted, he faces a sentence of up to six months in jail or a maximum fine of £5,000. We await the book deal—Tom Clancy's Spam Force!

POVERTY LINE

Being Microsoft

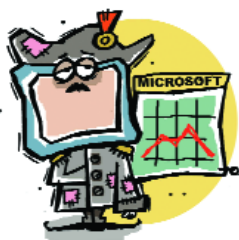
OK, don't laugh. Microsoft CEO says that the \$50-plus billion Microsoft is not as rich as it sounds. According to Bill Gates' chosen top man, stories of unfathomable riches are, just like Mark Twain's death we would presume, greatly exaggerated.

In a sermon e-mail to his staff, he intoned the pitfalls of capitalism, "We're a technology company with a lot of growth opportunities... Our

cash needs are always bigger than naked-eye observers might think," he then stepped down from his throne of solid-gold, removed his hat made up of US greenbacks and took a dive into the cash-pool, Uncle Scrooge style.

The \$50-plus billion Microsoft is not as rich as it sounds, says the software giant's CEO, Steve Ballmer

According to Ballmer, a hiccup in the cash flow came about when Microsoft spent, while the rest of the industry hung to dear paisa. This was circa economic-slump, which saw companies shed workers like yesterday's fashion; Microsoft, Ballmer said, was then busy investing while revenue was trying to catch up to the associated runaway costs.



"This obviously is not a trend we can continue," he declared. "This year, we are targeting nearly \$1 billion (Rs 4,600 crore) in efficiency improvement and cost

reduction across the company, primarily by rethinking how we do things." The rethinking has already seen the death of a few cafeterias and a reduction in the discount that employees receive when purchasing Microsoft stock.

To end with a cheery note, Ballmer said that he was happy with the PC industry and expected much love in the form of money. Amen!

OPEN AND SHUT CASE

Open Source is Evil

And still on Microsoft, Alone for the road. The company's chairman and chief software architect, who answers to the name of Bill Gates, doesn't like Open Source software. At all. And he wants everyone to hate it too. Why? OK, here is the history behind the statement.

On a recent visit to Malaysia, he made it a point to scare governments and companies away from this fast-approaching threat to his business. Don't get us wrong, the Open Source movement is far from the messiah-of-the-masses that

They changed Computing

David J. Bradley

Few would achieve immortality for spending five minutes sitting in front of a computer. That is precisely what David J. Bradley, retired head of Systems Architecture, IBM and one of the twelve people behind the first IBM PC, has achieved.

None of us even pause and think of the serendipities that gave us little things that have changed our worlds. Take for instance the well known key combination [Ctrl]+[Alt]+[Del], the 'three-finger-salute'. Any



PC user would tell you that it is the holy elixir for hung sessions and crashed computers.

Every day, millions of Windows users reach for these keys in frustration, trepidation or even contempt, only to forget all about it a few minutes later.

Bradley joined IBM in 1975 as an engineer at Boca Raton, California. He wrote the famous piece of code in five minutes some time in 1980-81. His claim to fame comes from those five minutes. The idea was to reset the PC without having to actually turn off the power and then turn it back on.

David J. Bradley retired from IBM at the age of 55.